

Configuring sound card drivers is important when setting up the speakers



D. Inserting the subwoofer speaker connector to the back panel of the PC

Once this is done, connect the other colour-coded audio cables to the back of the subwoofer (image F). Since the jacks are labelled, you are spared the guessing game!



E. The final assembly on the back panel of the computer

Once the speaker cables are connected to the back panel of the computer, we can concentrate on the speaker itself. For most part, we shall deal with the subwoofer.



F. Connected audio cables on the back panel of the subwoofer

All multimedia PC speaker satellites connect to the subwoofer by means of a connecting wire. These wires may or may not be colour-coded and labelled. Generally, they are not, but if they are then it is definitely a plus for easy installation of



G. Connecting the satellites

speakers. The image G depicts connecting a single satellite connector to the subwoofer.

The final assembly of cables on the back of the subwoofer is shown in image H.

This completes the hardware connections part for speakers. Next, we move into the driver configuration for speakers.



H. The final Subwoofer assembly

The Driver Deal

After connecting the speakers, it's time to configure the drivers. For most motherboards, integrated sound solutions are based on the Realtek AC6XX chips. High-end motherboards have ALC8XX chips.

However, some motherboards such as the Asus A7N8XE-Deluxe are based on the Nforce 2 chipset, which uses the extremely good SoundStorm audio solution. Newer motherboards such as the MSI P4N Diamond SLI have the Creative Live! 24-bit chip as the on-board audio solution.

Since Realtek is the generic chip that most motherboards have, we will stick to that. You

can access the driver configuration panel by either going to **Start > All Programs**, and locating the name of the program, which could either be Realtek or Soundmax, and clicking the Control Panel.

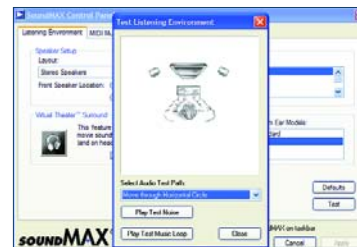
Alternatively, double-click the System Tray icon at the bottom of the screen for opening the driver configuration panel.

Once you have opened the driver configuration panel, you will see that the default option is chosen as 'stereo speakers'. So we will have to change the default option to '5.1 speakers'.

With that done, we need to test if each channel is properly configured. Press the 'Test' button at the bottom of the configuration panel, and choose the default settings.



I. Changing the speaker options



J. Click the 'Play Test Noise' button

Now, click the 'Play Test Noise' button. This will play the noise from each of the speakers including the subwoofer. If everything sounds as it should then you are done. The next step would be to put up your feet and relax! ☑

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